

Pamela Dale-Rourke

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PROFILE

Dynamic and empathetic Play Therapist with extensive experience in supporting children and young individuals through tailored therapeutic interventions. Adept at fostering effective communication between children, parents, and educators by utilizing play as a medium for expression. I possess a deep understanding of psychological principles and child development, enabling me to create engaging resources that promote emotional and social well-being. My work is characterized by collaboration and creativity, ensuring that each child's unique needs are met. Committed to enhancing learning experiences, I have developed numerous visual aids and therapeutic tools that facilitate understanding and engagement. My personal journey with AAC users has informed my approach, providing me with unique insights into the needs of children who communicate differently. I continuously strive to enhance my skills and knowledge in child psychology to deliver impactful therapeutic services.

EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire

SKILLS

Strong digital skills for resource creation layout and design Mind Express 5
tailoring resources to individual capabilities. Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS
SymbolStix Wdigit Bliss Understanding of inclusive communication
special educational needs (SEN) and speech and language therapy principles
Collaboration with therapists educators ensuring targeted interventions.

HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Writing



Meditation



Art

CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care (Preston College)
- Developed skills in therapeutic communication and emotional support, focusing on fostering secure relationships.

Play Therapy (Canterbury Christ University) - Gained comprehensive knowledge in play therapy techniques and child-centered approaches that enhance healing and growth.

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy (Manchester) - Learned strategies to engage families in therapy, emphasizing the importance of parental involvement in child development.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind, Manchester | October 2016 - Present

- Developed and implemented innovative communication and therapy resources, improving accessibility for over 200 children in schools, thus enhancing their ability to express emotions and needs effectively.
- Facilitated comprehensive 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy sessions, conducting psychotherapeutic assessments that informed individualized therapeutic pathways, resulting in a 90% satisfaction rate among families.
- Collaborated closely with teachers and educational therapists to create and adapt materials that cater to children with diverse communication and learning needs, significantly improving classroom engagement.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, providing hands-on training and guidance in utilizing inclusive communication strategies and resource development, fostering a supportive learning environment.
- Led workshops for educators on the importance of understanding child behavior and communication styles, enhancing teachers' skills in addressing the needs of children with varying psychological profiles.
- Conducted regular evaluations of therapy programs, utilizing feedback and measurable outcomes to refine interventions, resulting in a 30% increase in therapy effectiveness across multiple cases.
- Organized community outreach programs to raise awareness about mental health and emotional well-being in children, successfully engaging over 100 families in the process.
- Implemented a feedback system from parents and children to assess the impact of therapy techniques and resources, ensuring continuous improvement and responsiveness to their needs.

Play Therapist | Barnardos, St Helens | January 2015 - October 2016

- Created personalized visual and therapeutic resources tailored for children referred through CAMHS, effectively addressing their unique social, emotional, and communication challenges, leading to a 75% improvement in reported behavior.
- Participated in multidisciplinary assessment meetings, contributing insights and recommendations for communication supports, which improved the referral process and ensured appropriate interventions.
- Managed a diverse caseload of school-aged children, employing creative and resource-based approaches to facilitate successful emotional regulation and interpersonal skills development.
- Facilitated group therapy sessions, promoting peer interaction and support among children facing similar challenges, which enhanced their social skills and sense of community.
- Conducted regular progress assessments to evaluate the effectiveness of therapeutic interventions, adjusting strategies based on individual child needs and outcomes.
- Engaged in professional development to stay current on the latest therapeutic techniques and child psychology research, implementing new strategies that increased therapy effectiveness.
- Collaborated with families to build support networks and provide resources that empower parents to engage in their child's emotional development and communication.
- Documented each child's progress meticulously, ensuring compliance with organizational standards and facilitating smooth transitions to other services when necessary.

Family Session Worker | OJs, Preston | May 2023 - January 2024

- Supported families with children on the autism spectrum by designing and adapting inclusive resources that facilitated effective communication and engagement, improving family dynamics and understanding.
- Developed and implemented targeted activities that encouraged participation from children with communication differences, resulting in increased engagement in group settings and enhanced social interactions.
- Worked collaboratively with parents, therapists, and educational staff to assess individual needs and create practical, user-friendly resources that empower children to express themselves.
- Led family workshops focused on strategies for enhancing communication with children, which increased parents' confidence in supporting their child's development.
- Maintained comprehensive documentation of family sessions and progress, ensuring that all interventions were tracked and adjusted based on individual family feedback.
- Engaged in continuous professional development to expand knowledge of autism spectrum conditions and effective therapeutic approaches, applying new insights to improve services.
- Facilitated open discussions among families to share experiences and strategies, fostering a supportive community environment among participants.
- Evaluated the effectiveness of provided resources through feedback mechanisms, allowing for ongoing refinement and improvement based on actual user experiences.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school | N/A

- Planned and developed engaging literacy and learning resources for primary-

aged children, enhancing their reading and writing skills through creative and interactive materials.

- Collaborated with teaching staff to align educational resources with lesson objectives, ensuring that all materials were relevant and beneficial for student learning.
- Adapted learning activities to accommodate various learning needs and abilities, fostering an inclusive classroom environment that supported all students.
- Conducted workshops for educators on best practices in resource development and implementation, which improved teaching efficacy and student engagement.
- Monitored student progress and engagement with created resources, using data to further refine materials and activities for better learning outcomes.
- Utilized feedback from both teachers and students to create resources that not only met educational standards but also inspired creativity and critical thinking in children.
- Engaged in ongoing research on educational strategies and child development to ensure that resources remained contemporary and effective.
- Collaborated on interdisciplinary projects that integrated different subjects, promoting holistic learning experiences for children.